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It is often said success has many fathers. The real and only father of INDIA TODAY was, in fact, my father, V.V. Purie. He launched many successful ventures in his life and one of them was INDIA TODAY. It was his idea and he started it 32 years ago. Not many people know this because he didn't believe in self-promotion. Last week he passed away.

He had a full and good life. He lived life on his own terms and so it was even in his death. He wrote me a letter 16 years ago saying that he had passed his father's and grandfather's age and he will pass away one day. He requested his children not to indulge in eulogising him as he said was the practice in our country. He hated hypocrisy. He didn't want us to mourn and thanked his friends for their love and support. So we let go of him with quiet grace.

He probably wouldn't approve of me writing this but I feel I must because an era has passed and the values which he

imbued in the magazine and the rest of the India Today Group are worth stating. The values of uncompromising integrity, self-confidence, independence and fearlessness. Never to take favours. Fight for what you believe is right. Don't promote personality cults. Regardless of what others do, don't descend to their level. Come what may, always maintain your dignity and be true to yourself. Celebrate life



V.V. Purie
Founder, INDIA TODAY

and have the curiosity of an adventurer. These were taught not by preaching or lectures but by just living that way.

For me, he was a great father. I believe there are three things parents can give to their children: unconditional love, a good education and wonderful memories. My father gave me all in full measure. Beyond that the greatest gift a father can give his son, specially a successful father, is the freedom to grow. He gave me this even before I had the confidence in myself. He believed in me and I hope I didn't disappoint him. He is no longer with us but his fierce intrepid spirit still lives on in the magazine and will continue to do so.

This issue's cover story is on one of India's most controversial politicians fighting for re-election: Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi, put together by Executive Editor S. Prasannarajan and Associate Editor Uday Mahurkar. Prasannarajan travelled to Gujarat to cover his election campaign. He says, "There is a terrifying sense of mission about the man." Modi is at his demagogic best and is the only issue in the election. Gujarat is not just another state election, its result will have repercussions across the political spectrum.

Aroon Purie
(Aroon Purie)